

500 BILLION DOLLARS

THE DECLINE IN THE VALUE OF QUOTED SHARES ON BLACK MONDAY

The New York Stock Exchange crash on "Black Monday" saw the Dow Jones drop more than 500 points.

5

BILLION

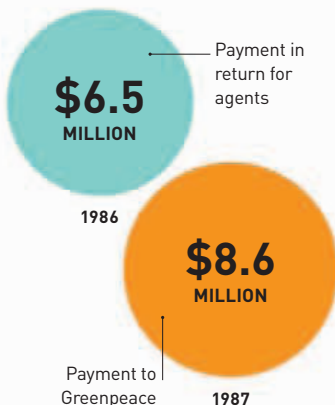
THE WORLD POPULATION IN 1987

IN JULY, THE WORLD POPULATION REACHED FIVE BILLION. This was double what it was in 1950, and a **billion higher** than in 1974. The population of the world was growing at a rate of **220,000 people a day**. Much of the growth was seen in parts of the world least able to sustain it. The concern about the social and economic impact of population growth led to July 11 being known as the **Day of Five Billion**. Thereafter, July 11 became **World Population Day**.



Terry Waite (b. 1939), special envoy to the Archbishop of Canterbury, traveled to Lebanon, in January, to seek the **release of hostages** from Western countries, including the journalist **John McCarthy** (see 1986). However, he himself was **captured by militants** and held in **Beirut** (see 1991).

In May, **France** was forced to pay \$8.6 million to **Greenpeace** for the sinking of their flagship, **Rainbow Warrior**. The vessel, which was to lead a Greenpeace flotilla protesting against **French nuclear testing** in the Pacific, had been sunk by an explosion on July 10, 1985, in **Auckland harbor**, New Zealand. A photographer, **Fernando Pereira**, was killed in the blast. The incident provoked an **international scandal** and led to the cooling of relations between New Zealand and France. Two **French secret agents**, implicated in the bombing, were imprisoned. France paid \$6.5 million to New Zealand as **compensation** and for returning its agents to French jurisdiction.



French compensation

France paid New Zealand \$6.5 million to return its agents. It also paid \$8.6 million to Greenpeace for the sinking of its ship, Rainbow Warrior.

On March 20, the drug azidothymidine (**AZT**) was approved by the US Food and Drug Administration. It was the first antiretroviral drug made specifically to combat **HIV/AIDS**. While AZT could not cure AIDS, it proved that the disease could be managed, and that HIV was not a death sentence.

On October 19, the **Dow-Jones average** in the US declined by 22.6 percent—the **largest single-day percentage drop** in its history. The next day, the London Stock Exchange saw £50 billion wiped off its share values.

Negotiating freedom

Terry Waite became a familiar figure in Lebanon. As a church envoy, he made many missions to negotiate the release of hostages held by Islamic militant organizations.

Stock markets around the globe also **plummeted**. The crash was triggered by fears about the weak dollar and the **US trade deficit**. It was aggravated by news of the US retaliating against Iranian attacks in the Persian Gulf by bombing an oil rig. "**Black Monday**," as it came to be known, was almost twice as bad as the crash of October 29, 1929.

Margaret Thatcher (b. 1925) visited **Moscow** in March. It was the first official visit by a British prime minister in 12 years, and marked the **normalization of British-Soviet ties**. During the talks, **Mikhail Gorbachev** (b. 1931), the Soviet premier, condemned the Brezhnev doctrine and called the "**Iron Curtain**" archaic, suggesting more liberal policies toward Eastern Europe. The next month, Gorbachev visited Prague, Czechoslovakia, and implied that the Eastern Bloc countries could be **independent**.

In December, the leaders of the **USSR and US signed a treaty** to reduce the size of their ground-based nuclear arsenal. Known as the **Intermediate-range Nuclear Forces (INF) Treaty**, its aim was to reverse the nuclear arms race by destroying all medium- and short-range nuclear weapons in Europe, capable of hitting targets at ranges of 300–3,000 miles (500–5,500 km). This was the first time the superpowers had agreed to **reduce** their massive **nuclear arsenals**.

January 1 Thousands of students march in Tiananmen Square, Beijing, China

January 20 Terry Waite, hostage negotiator, disappears in Beirut

March 20 AZT drug introduced to combat AIDS

April 21 Tamil Tigers blamed for Colombo bomb attack, which killed over 100

June 22 Death of American dancer and actor **Fred Astaire** (b. 1893)

August 17 Death of **Rudolf Hess** (b. 1894), Hitler's deputy

August 19 **Michael Ryan** shoots 14 dead in Hungerford, England

October 16 Hurricane rocks Britain; 13 die

November 8 IRA bomb Remembrance Day parade in Enniskillen, Northern Ireland

December 8 Superpowers sign INF Treaty to reduce nuclear arsenal

January 15 Israeli soldiers clash with Palestinians outside Temple Mount, East Jerusalem

January 15 Death of **Sean McBride** (b. 1904), Amnesty International cofounder

March 6 The English Channel ferry Herald of Free Enterprise capsizes, killing nearly 200

April 19 The Simpsons cartoon show launched on Tracey Ullman Show

May 2 France pays Greenpeace compensation for sinking Rainbow Warrior

July 3 "Butcher of Lyons", Klaus Barbie, found guilty of wartime atrocities

July 11 World population reaches 5 billion

August 28 Death of American film director **John Huston** (b. 1906)

October 19 "Black Monday": stocks around the world tumble

November 18 Fire at King's Cross Station, London; 30 die

December 15 Digging begins in Britain for Channel Tunnel to France

March 6 IRA gang shot dead in Gibraltar by SAS

March 16 Iraq drops chemical bombs on Kurdish town of Halabja

April 1 Stephen Hawking publishes A Brief History of Time